Lab 23: Commit the server, never the token

Topic 2: Tool Design & MCP Integration · Task 2.4: Integrate MCP servers into Claude Code and agent workflows

Runs on Simulator 2: Code Generation with Claude Code · Run in class

Source: Built from exam guide task statement 2.4 (no practice question covers this angle)

The question

Your team needs the same GitHub and docs MCP servers, but each token is personal. Where does the configuration go?

A. A shared .mcp.json with a literal secret, or a server only you have.

B. ${GITHUB_TOKEN} in the project file, experiments in user scope.

Simulate it live

```
# In the browser: open Simulator 2, then Lab 23
cd labs
uv run serve.py

# In Claude Code, from the labs folder
/lab 23

# In a terminal, from simulators/simulator-2-code-generation/
uv run simulator.py 5
```

What you should see

.mcp.json holds placeholders only. Your real ~/.claude.json stays untouched.

Open `simulators/simulator-2-code-generation/evidence/` and find it yourself.

The answer

B. ${GITHUB_TOKEN} in the project file, experiments in user scope.

Now change one thing

Set LAB_MODEL=claude-sonnet-5-5, rerun, and compare the result and the cost line in evidence/.